H-B-56
DECEMBER 8, 1931

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BROOMS; FIBER

This specification was approved for promulgation by the Federal Specifications Board on December 8, 1931, for the use of the departments and independent establishments of the Government in the purchase of this commodity, and shall become mandatory for all departments and independent establishments of the Government not later than May 1, 1932. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS.

A–1. There are no other Federal specifications applicable to this specification.

B. TYPE AND SIZES.

B–1. *Type.*—Fiber brooms shall be of but one type.

B–2. *Sizes.*—They shall be of the following sizes, as specified:

28 pounds to the dozen.
32 pounds to the dozen.
36 pounds to the dozen.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP, ETC.

C–1. *Material.*—See sections D and E.

C–2. *Workmanship.*—Fiber brooms shall be well made, free from avoidable imperfections.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D–1. *Body.*—Shall be of first quality Bass or Bassine fiber.

D–2. *Handle.*—May be of maple, beech, birch, Douglas fir, or hickory, free from knots, splits, and other imperfections, smoothly finished, and extending into the neck and body of the brooms not less than 2 inches. If Douglas fir is used it shall be finished with at least two coats of transparent varnish or lacquer.

D–3. *Fastening.*—The fibers shall be firmly set in cement or pitch and firmly bound with a pressed steel cap, properly lacquered to prevent rusting. Cap shall be through riveted with at least five galvanized-iron rivets and secured to handle by two or more galvanized-iron rivets.

D–4. *Ties and stitches.*—Broom body shall be firmly held in shape by ties of best cable laid No. 18 3-ply real linen twine. On the 32-pound and 36-pound brooms the row of stitches farthest from the neck may be dropped to space a greater distance.

D–5. *Tolerances.*—A plus or minus tolerance of ¼ inch will be allowed in the length of neck and length of body, and ½ inch in width of body at end.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

	Sizes		
	28-pound	32-pound	36-pound
E–1. *Neck* (length) (inches)	2	2	2
E–2. *Broom body.*—			
E–2a. Length (inches)	10	10	10
E–2b. Width at end (inches)	14	14	14
E–2c. Hold of fibers in cap (minimum) (inches)	1½	1½	1½
E–2d. Width at base of cap (minimum) (inches)	6¼	6¼	6¼
E–3. *Handles.*—			
E–3a. Total length out of cap (minimum) (inches)	40	40	40
E–3b. Approximate diameter (inch)	15/16	1	1
E–4. *Ties.*—			
E–4a. Number of	2	2	2
E–4b. Distance of first tie from base of cap (inches)	1¾	1¾	1¾
E–4c. Distance between ties (inch)	⅝	⅝	⅝
E–4d. Stitches (number per tie)	9–12	9–12	9–12
E–5. *Dry weight* per dozen, unpacked (minimum) (pounds)	27½	31½	35½

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS.

F–1. One broom from every lot of 10 dozen or fraction thereof shall be inspected for compliance with this specification, and 1 dozen brooms from every such lot shall be tested for weight.

G. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING.

G–1. *Packaging.*—Brooms shall be packed in bundles of one-half dozen or 1 dozen each; the ends of the brooms to be securely fastened together.

G–2. *Packing.*—The bundles shall be delivered in standard commercial containers so constructed as to insure acceptance by common or other carrier, for safe transportation, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery.

G-3. *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material, the quantity and the weight per dozen as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H-1. The following departmental specifications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall form a part of this specification:

Navy Department: General Specifications for Inspection of Material (copies of which may be obtained, without cost, upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.).

I. NOTES.

I-1. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I-2. This specification governs all United States Government purchases of this commodity. Users are requested to retain this specification in permanent file until a revision is issued.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility or any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, in or any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.